was not through creation of a Palestinian state, but through some sort of political association of these areas with the government of Jordan under which the Palestinians would have self-rule and autonomy, perhaps like an American state.

Thus, we believed that the solution lay in what came to be known as the “land for peace” option: Israel’s withdrawal, under provisions of UN Security Council Resolution 242, from Gaza and most of the West Bank and an undivided Jerusalem, in exchange for peace and the Arabs’ acceptance of its right to exist. I felt then—and still do—that Israel will never resolve its conflict with the Arabs unless it gives up some of the land won in the 1967 war in return for peace and safe borders, and that so long as Israel continues building new settlements in the occupied territories, a lasting peace will remain extremely difficult to forge.

In my view, Israel wouldn’t have to return *all* of the forty-mile-wide stretch of land between the Mediterranean and the West Bank of the Jordan River; there are one or two points along the West Bank near the narrowest portion of Israel’s pre-1967 borders that Israel could retain because of its legitimate security concerns—to prevent, for example, hostile artillery from firing into Israel. But without Israel agreeing to “land for peace,” I don’t think there will ever be peace in the Middle East.

By late August of 1982, with the cease-fire still in place, we had completed work on the details of our new Middle East peace initiative; I planned to announce it in a nationally televised speech on September 1. Several days before that, officials of our administration presented an outline of the plan to the leaders of Saudi Arabia and Jordan. This was part of our long effort to persuade King Hussein to take part in negotiations with Israel. We were never able to get him completely on board. Expecting Begin to look unfavorably on any proposal that called on Israel to give up any part of